New joiner onboarding checklist for IT

Article KB0010013 | Owner: Identity & Access Management | Subcategory: New joiner setup | Applies to: New joiners (all locations and remote), Windows 11 laptops (Dell Latitude 5440/7440, Lenovo ThinkPad T14/X1 Carbon, HP EliteBook 840), macOS laptops (MacBook Pro/Air on macOS 14/15), Microsoft Entra ID (Azure AD) + on-prem Active Directory, Microsoft 365 suite (Outlook, Teams, OneDrive, SharePoint), Intune-managed devices and Company Portal, Palo Alto GlobalProtect VPN (certificate-based), PaperCut secure print release

Summary

This article provides a complete onboarding checklist for new joiners at Acme Global, covering IT account creation, device provisioning, license assignment, MFA enrollment, and verification steps. It outlines what managers and HR should prepare before the start date, gives new joiners a self-help procedure they can follow on day?one, and details the exact steps the Service Desk L1 (or Identity & Access Management) team must perform to fulfil a standard new-hire request.

Symptoms

- Unable to sign in to Windows with domain credentials - error 'The username or password is incorrect'
- Outlook shows 'We couldn't find your mailbox' or no mailbox appears
- Microsoft Teams prompts for sign-in and fails after entering credentials
- OneDrive shows 'Set up OneDrive' and never syncs
- GlobalProtect VPN connection fails with 'Certificate validation error'
- Print jobs stay in 'Hold for authentication' state in PaperCut

Common causes

- HR employee record not yet loaded into the identity provisioning pipeline
- AD account creation delayed beyond the agreed start date
- Mailbox not created or Microsoft 365 licence not assigned to the new user
- Device not pre-enrolled in Intune before the user's first login
- MFA not yet enrolled, causing Conditional Access to block sign-in
- VPN user certificate not issued or has expired
- PaperCut user record missing or badge not linked to the AD account

Pre-Start Preparation (HR/Manager)

Before the new joiner's first day, HR must ensure the employee record is entered into the HRIS with a confirmed start date. This triggers the automated identity-creation workflow that provisions an AD account, mailbox, and default Microsoft 365 licences. The hiring manager should submit a hardware request through the IT service portal (or via the designated equipment-order form) specifying the preferred laptop model and any accessories. Early submission allows the Desktop Support team to image the device, enroll it in Intune, and have it ready for pickup or shipment.

Self-Help Checklist for New Joiners

On your first day, follow these steps to verify that your IT environment is ready. If any step fails, note the exact error message and contact the IT Service Desk (phone?4357, Teams channel "IT Help", or the self-service portal https://it.acme.example).

1. Power on the laptop and connect to the ACME-Corp Wi-Fi (802.1X) or plug in the Ethernet cable. The device should automatically authenticate using its machine certificate.
2. At the Windows login screen, enter your Acme Global username in the format <firstname>.<lastname>@acme.example and your temporary password provided by your manager or HR.
3. If prompted, complete the Microsoft Authenticator MFA registration: open the app, scan the QR code shown on screen, and approve the push notification.
4. Once logged in, open Outlook and confirm that your mailbox loads and you can see the default Inbox folder.
5. Launch Microsoft Teams; you should be signed in automatically and see your teams and chats.
6. Open OneDrive from the Start menu; it should begin syncing your Files On-Demands folder without errors.
7. Optional - test VPN: launch the GlobalProtect client, connect to vpn.acme.example, and verify you receive a

'Connected' status.
8. Optional - test printing: open any document, choose Print, select the PaperCut secure print queue, release the job at a printer using your ID badge.

Service-Desk Agent Onboarding Procedure

When a ticket arrives requesting new-joiner setup, the L1 agent (or the Identity & Access Management team) follows this checklist to ensure all accounts, licences, and devices are provisioned correctly. Attach the completed checklist to the ticket and mark the ticket as Resolved once verification is successful.

1. Verify the HR-provided start date and employee ID in the ticket or HRIS lookup. If the start date is in the future, note that the account will be enabled on that date.
2. Search Entra ID for the user principal name (UPN). If the account does not exist, create it using the standard naming convention <firstname>.<lastname>@acme.example, set a strong temporary password (14+ characters, meets complexity), and enable the account.
3. Assign the user to the 'Acme-Standard-User' security group which grants the default set of Microsoft 365 licences (E5 or as defined by role) and adds the user to the appropriate distribution lists.
4. Create an Exchange Online mailbox (if not auto-provisioned) and apply the corresponding licence; confirm the mailbox appears in the Exchange admin center with a 50?GB primary mailbox plus online archive.
5. Ensure the user's device (laptop) is pre-enrolled in Intune: verify the device appears under Intune?->?Devices with compliance status 'Compliant' and that the required applications (Company Portal, Microsoft 365 apps, endpoint security) are installed.
6. If the device is not yet with the user, arrange for delivery or pickup and provide the asset tag and serial number to the manager.
7. Instruct the user to complete MFA enrollment via Microsoft Authenticator (push) and, if needed, set up a backup SMS method. Issue a Temporary Access Pass only if the user cannot complete the MFA flow and the IAM team has approved it.
8. Communicate the temporary password and MFA enrolment instructions to the user's manager (or directly to the user if they have an alternate email/phone). Ask the manager to share the credentials securely.

Verification and Closure

After the onboarding steps are completed, the service-desk agent must confirm that the new joiner can work effectively. Document the verification outcomes in the ticket and provide any final guidance to the user.

1. Ask the user to sign in to Windows with their permanent password (after the first-login prompt to change it). Confirm they reach the desktop without errors.
2. Verify Outlook connectivity: send and receive a test email to/from the user's own address.
3. Confirm Teams chat and call functionality by sending a quick message to a known contact.
4. Check OneDrive sync status: look for the blue cloud icon indicating sync is healthy.
5. If VPN is required, have the user establish a GlobalProtect session and browse to an internal site (e.g., the intranet) to validate access.
6. Test printing: print a test page, release it via PaperCut using the ID badge, and ensure the job completes successfully.
7. Once all checks pass, close the ticket with resolution 'Onboarding completed - user able to log in, access mailbox, Teams, OneDrive, VPN, and print.' Include the asset tag, laptop model, and any exceptions noted.

Common Issues and Troubleshooting

Even with a standard process, occasional hiccups occur. Below are frequent symptoms and the first-line actions the service desk can take. If the problem persists after these steps, escalate to the appropriate specialist group with the details gathered.

1. User cannot log in - 'The username or password is incorrect': Verify the account is not locked out (lockout after 5 failed attempts for 15?minutes). Reset the password via the self-service portal https://passwordreset.acme.example or issue a new temporary password and inform the user.
2. Outlook shows no mailbox: Check that an Exchange Online licence is assigned and that the mailbox has been created (may take up to 30?minutes after licence assignment). Re-sync the mailbox by removing and re-adding the

account in Outlook.
3. Teams sign-in loop: Ensure the user has completed MFA registration. If MFA is pending, Conditional Access will block access. Guide the user through the Authenticator setup or issue a Temporary Access Pass via IAM.
4. OneDrive stuck on 'Setting up...': Confirm the device is compliant in Intune and that the OneDrive sync app is installed. Try resetting the sync app via Settings?->?Accounts?->?Access work or school ->?Disconnect, then reconnect.
5. VPN connection fails with certificate error: Validate that the user certificate has been issued and is not expired. Renew the certificate via the GlobalProtect portal if needed, or re-enroll the device for machine certificate.
6. Printing held in PaperCut: Verify the user's PaperCut record is linked to their AD username. If missing, add the user to PaperCut using the admin console and ensure the ID badge is assigned.

When to escalate

Escalate to Identity & Access Management when: the AD account cannot be found or created despite HR confirmation, mailbox provisioning fails after licence assignment, or MFA/Temporary Access Pass issuance is required beyond the L1 scope. Escalate to Desktop Support if the laptop fails to enroll in Intune, BitLocker/FileVault encryption is missing, or hardware defects prevent inclusion in the onboarding kit. When escalating, include the employee ID, start date, laptop serial/asset tag, screenshots of any error messages, and a summary of steps already attempted.

Keywords: new joiner onboarding, account setup, laptop provisioning, MFA enrollment, Entra ID, mailbox creation, Intune compliance, GlobalProtect VPN, PaperCut printing, self service password reset, temporary access pass, onboarding checklist